Listening Passages

Unit 1

Gopal, Varun and Muthu would go swimming in the sea in summer. They would sit down and watch the waves tumbling towards the shore. They'd chase the gulls whenever they saw them flying over the oyster catchers. They'd skim stones if the sea was calm enough – twenty six bounces was Gopal's record – Varun had only ever managed two! Whatever they did, wherever they went, the three of them were always together.

Unit 2

In English we say it is raining cats and dogs when it rains heavily. For the people of Gollamudi in Andhra Pradesh, however, it rained fish!

In the early hours of the morning yesterday, people were woken up to a 'rain of fish'. Four to six inches - long fish were found on the roads and in the waterlogged fields of this village. Some of the fish were still alive. News spread rapidly and soon, people were out collecting the fish. Locals said it was a fish not usually found there.

Environmentalists say that very strong winds and gales sometimes carry fish and sea animals along with the water from rivers and canals. They then can come down with the rain many miles away. This is what happened in Gollamudi.

Unit 3

The Tale of The Pencil

Raj was upset because he had done poorly in his English test. His grandmother sat with him and gave him a pencil. A puzzled Raj looked at his grandma and said he didn't deserve a pencil after his performance in the test. His grandma explained, 'You can learn a great many things from this pencil because it is just like you. It experiences a painful sharpening, just the way you have experienced the pain of not doing well in your test. However, it will help you be a better student. Just as all the good that comes from the pencil is from within itself, you will also find the strength to overcome this hurdle. And finally, just as this pencil will make its mark on any surface, you too shall leave your mark on anything you choose to.' Raj was immediately consoled and promised himself that he would do better in future.

Moral of The Story

We all have the strength to be who we wish to be.

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